

Silly Sentence Smash!

Requirements

Index cards with pictures representing target words (minimal pairs if needed)

Small prizes or stickers (optional)

Instructions

Preparation (5 minutes): Select target words based on the student's identified phonological processes. Write each target word on a separate index card and illustrate it with a picture. If working on minimal pairs, prepare cards for both words in the pair (e.g., "toe" and "sew" if targeting fronting). Lay out the cards face up on the table, ensuring the child can see them clearly.

Sentence Building (15 minutes): Explain to the student that they will be building silly sentences using the picture cards. Model a silly sentence using a few of the cards (e.g., if the cards are "cat," "eat," and "sock," say, "The cat will eat the sock!"). Encourage the student to create their own sentences, using at least 3-4 cards per sentence. Emphasize clear articulation of the target sounds within the words. Prompt correct pronunciation if needed, using techniques learned in prior sessions (e.g., tactile cues, visual aids).

Silly Smash (5 minutes): After the student creates each sentence and attempts to say it clearly, have them dramatically "smash" or crumple the cards used in the sentence. This provides a fun physical action and signals the completion of that sentence. Alternatively, the student can simply turn the cards over once the sentence has been spoken.

Reinforcement and Review (5 minutes): Provide positive reinforcement throughout the activity. At the end, review any words that were particularly difficult. If using prizes or stickers, award them based on effort and attempts at clear articulation, not necessarily perfect pronunciation.